EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 26 OCTOBER 2026

ZIP 95820, Tahoe Park and Colonial Heights, Sacramento

The winter danger here is wind on saturated soil: falling trees, multi-day SMUD outages, and cold, wet nights for unhoused people. The first move is to reach the Medicare beneficiaries who depend on power or dialysis before the first storm.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Sacramento County, CA (inferred)	None published for the US, California, or the county	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Wind on saturated soil: falling trees and multi-day SMUD outages; cold and wet for unhoused people

14/14 recommendations checked. 1 confirmed outright, 7 corrected, 0 unverified, 6 contraindicated (the six Do-not cards). The funding target is unchanged at $60,000. One candidate placement (no-cook food boxes, $40,000) was not added. The 5 resident steps (added 26 October 2026) were checked separately: 1 confirmed, 4 corrected. The battery money for Resources for Independent Living in the three Sacramento briefings (Curtis Park, South Land Park, and this one) should be one pool, not three. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk*, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States, California, or Sacramento County, and heat is not this place's winter hazard. No population-scaled figure is given here.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



38.54°N 121.44°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** In January 2023 about 1,500 trees fell citywide and 345,000 SMUD customers lost power at the peak. No storm death is on record inside 95820.
- **For you.** By 15 Nov, if anyone at home uses oxygen or dialysis, enrol in SMUD's free Medical Equipment Discount and ask about earlier dialysis before storms.*
- **The money.** $45,000 floor, $60,000 target, ~$78,000 ceiling. Most of it buys 30 power stations through one RIL pool shared with 95818 and 95822.
- **Do not.** Do not hand out generators, gas heaters, or grills: an indoor generator left a south Sacramento mother and two children critical in 2024.*

For you, as a resident	5 steps	p. 2
What to do	**8** actions	p. 5
Who does what	RACI chart	p. 12
Where money does the most	funding	p. 12
Do not do this	**6** items	p. 14
What has happened here	the record	p. 16
How this was produced	methodology	p. 18
References	sources	p. 20

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Trigger on each storm forecast, not on the El Niño label. The strong 2015–16 El Niño under-delivered in Northern California. The January 2023 disaster came in a La Niña winter. Every action below fires on a National Weather Service wind or atmospheric-river forecast.

Two governments serve this ZIP. About 89% of its land is the City of Sacramento: Tahoe Park (with East, South, and West Tahoe Park), Tallac Village, Colonial Heights, Colonial Manor, Colonial Village, Lawrence Park, and part of Oak Park. The other 11% is unincorporated Fruitridge Pocket (2020 population 6,102), which lies entirely inside the ZIP and is served by Sacramento County. The southern edge is about Fruitridge Road, so Fruitridge Manor and almost all of Lemon Hill are in 95824, not here.

Who lives here. 35,410 people in 13,511 households (ACS 2024 5-year). Poverty is 17.1%, against 12.5% countywide, and 41% rent. About 40% are Hispanic. 1,072 households have limited English, 636 of them Spanish-speaking. 5,042 people are 65 or over, and 1,250 of them live alone. 10.3% of adults report a utility shut-off threat, against 7.7% countywide (CDC PLACES, modelled).

Flood is not the main harm. FEMA maps the whole ZIP as Zone X: minimal hazard, the 0.2% annual-chance zone, or levee-reduced. There is no high-risk zone. Morrison Creek runs about 0.9 km south of the ZIP.

FOR YOU, AS A RESIDENT 5 STEPS

For a resident of this ZIP, a stormy winter means trees down on homes and cars, SMUD outages that run for days, and cold, dark nights. No role was given with the request, so this section is written for a resident. The ranked actions below are written for the County, the City, SMUD, and their partners. These are the steps you can take yourself, with your own time and money.

1 · If anyone at home relies on powered medical equipment or dialysis, enrol in SMUD's Medical Equipment Discount and ask the dialysis unit about earlier sessions before storms

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 1

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
15 Nov 2026	None; the discount takes $15 a month off the bill	Anyone on oxygen, home dialysis, a ventilator, or dialysis at a clinic

The discount covers home dialysis machines, oxygen concentrators, ventilators, and electric wheelchairs, but not CPAP or BiPAP, and the form needs a clinician's signature. Before Hurricane Sandy, patients dialysed early were less likely to die within 30 days (OR 0.72; Lurie

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

et al., 2015), so ask the unit now whether it will move your session earlier when a storm is forecast.*

2 · Test or replace your CO alarm, and never run a generator, grill, or oven for heat indoors

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 4

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Before the first storm	About $25 per alarm (estimate)	Everyone asleep in the house

California's SB 183 already requires CO alarms in homes with gas appliances or an attached garage, so the usual gap is an expired or dead alarm; pick one with a battery, because a mains-only alarm dies in the outage. If you already own a generator, run it outdoors only, at least 20 feet from windows: in April 2024 a gas generator inside a south Sacramento apartment left a mother and two children in critical condition.*

3 · In a wind warning, stay off the roads and sleep away from rooms under big trees; report a large tree over your bedroom now

CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 5

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Report trees by 15 Nov; the rules apply in every warning	None	Everyone in the car and the bedroom

About 1,500 trees fell citywide in January 2023, most of them healthy trees uprooted from saturated soil, and 44% of US tree-fall deaths happen in vehicles (Schmidlin, 2009); one Tahoe Park family slept away from a tree over their bedroom that month. Report a street tree to City 311, or in Fruitridge Pocket to County 311 (916-875-4311), which covers trees in County road right-of-way; a tree on private land is its owner's job, so tell the owner.*

4 · If your income qualifies, apply for SMUD's low-income rate (EAPR) and HEAP by mid-November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

15 Nov 2026	None; EAPR is worth up to $105 a month	Your power and heat through the storm months

EAPR takes $105 a month off at 0–50% of the poverty line, down to $10 near 200%, and SMUD says processing takes 2–4 weeks, so a December application may not land before the storms. HEAP runs through Community Resource Project (916-567-5200); its 2026–27 opening date is unconfirmed, so call to check.

5 · If you get CalFresh and an outage spoils your food, file form CF 303 within 10 days

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED FROM ACTION 7

BY WHEN	COST TO YOU	PROTECTS
Within 10 days of the food loss	None	Your household's food for the month

Replacement is capped at one month's allotment, and none is issued if the signed CF 303 arrives after 10 days; you can sign it by phone or file it in person, by mail, by fax, or online. After the January 2023 storms USDA approved replacement for Sacramento County, but it was automatic only in the hardest-hit ZIPs, so do not wait to be told.

Optional: flood cover. The whole ZIP is FEMA Zone X, so no lender requires flood insurance and cover is your choice. FEMA's authority to write new NFIP policies expires on 11 December 2026 unless Congress extends it, and new policies usually wait 30 days, so anyone who wants cover should buy by about 10 November.

What to ask of the people in charge

- Ask **Sacramento County Public Health** how a device user in 95820 gets reached before a storm, now that only the state can request the named emPOWER list (action 1).
- Ask **Sacramento County Homeless Services and Housing** and the **City Dept of Community Response** for the winter addendum: a Stockton Blvd pickup and a ride to an open respite site on storm nights (action 2).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Reach the power-dependent before the first storm: an emPOWER request route, earlier dialysis, SMUD's medical discount, and 30 loaned power stations

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sacramento County Public Health; dialysis units; SMUD; Resources for Independent Living (RIL); CDPH consulted	Request route and dialysis plan by 15 Nov	$30,000 for 30 power stations (estimate); the rest is staff time	Deaths from missed dialysis and failed oxygen or other devices in multi-day outages

HHS emPOWER, queried on 26 October 2026, counts 5,708 Medicare beneficiaries in 95820. 308 use electricity-dependent equipment. A separate count of 194 use dialysis (70), oxygen (48), home health (65), or hospice (11). Those service counts are not necessarily device users, so up to about 500 people are at risk, minus any overlap. Only the state (CDPH) can request the named emPOWER file, and only during or on the imminent threat of an emergency. So by 15 November the County agrees that request route with CDPH, and agrees with dialysis units to move sessions earlier before each forecast storm. Early dialysis before Hurricane Sandy was associated with lower odds of death within 30 days (OR 0.72, 95% CI 0.52–0.997; Lurie et al., *AJKD* 2015, observational). SMUD's Medical Equipment Discount takes $15 a month off the bill with a clinician's signature, but excludes CPAP and BiPAP. No SMUD or PG&E programme gives SMUD medical customers a storm battery, so RIL loans fill a real gap.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the 70, 48, 65, and 11 are not a subset of the 308. A standing named list by 15 November is not obtainable; the step is the pre-agreed request route. The battery cost is an estimate (2 kWh units sell for $749–899 on sale, $1,399–1,899 at list). RIL's capacity to run loans is unverified. The 30 units are this ZIP's share of one pool with 95818 and 95822. Transferability: the Sandy evidence comes from a forecast storm with days of warning, as atmospheric rivers give here.

2. Get unhoused people to a bed on storm nights: a winter addendum to the existing City–County agreement, with a Stockton Blvd pickup, a ride, and a log

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sacramento County Dept of Homeless Services and Housing; City Dept of Community Response	**Addendum by 1 Dec; outreach run the day before each storm**	**Staff time; rides already free on Regional Transit at activation**	**Deaths from cold, wet exposure and from trees falling on tents**

A City–County Homeless Services Partnership Agreement already exists (signed 6 December 2022, five years, covering the unincorporated County, with joint outreach). Ask for a winter addendum under it: a named pickup point on Stockton Blvd, a ride to whichever respite site is open, and a log of where each person ends up. Add an outreach run along the corridor the day before each storm. Neither City nor County restricts respite by residence. The real gaps are distance and triggers. The County's November 2025 site was at 4000 Branch Center Rd, about 8–10 km east, adults only, with free RT rides and a 2-1-1 capacity check. The City opens on an NWS high-wind watch or warning, a wind advisory, a severe thunderstorm watch or warning, or a 60% or greater chance of rain on two or more days, 1 September to 1 March. The County uses its own criteria.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Correction: the draft called for a new one-page agreement; one already exists. Evidence is thin. No study shows shelter on a weather trigger reduces deaths. The case rests on mechanism, on 8 unhoused hypothermia deaths in the county in 2021, and on two unhoused people killed by trees on their tents in January 2023 (not in 95820).

3. Run in-language storm check-ins for the 1,250 people aged 65+ who live alone and for device users, fired on each wind advisory or atmospheric-river watch

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
La Familia Counseling Center, with Fruit Ridge Community Collaborative, Iu Mien Community Services, and Asian Pacific Community Counseling	Rosters by 15 Nov; calls on each NWS wind advisory or atmospheric-river watch	$15,000 to Iu Mien Community Services (a capacity ceiling, not a costing)	Isolated older people left without heat, power, or help on day two of an outage

La Familia Counseling Center (5523 34th St, 95820; 916-452-3601) works in Spanish and English. The Fruit Ridge Community Collaborative (4625 44th St, 95820; 916-233-5153) houses about 25 nonprofits; its phone-tree capacity is unverified. Iu Mien Community Services sits on Stockton Blvd just outside the ZIP and serves the Mien community regionally (2024 revenue $328,273). Asian Pacific Community Counseling is the County-listed provider for Hmong. In the 1995 Chicago heat wave, living alone roughly doubled the odds of death (OR 2.3; Semenza et al., *NEJM* 1996).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: La Familia does not list Hmong service, so Hmong goes to Asian Pacific Community Counseling. Iu Mien is outside the ZIP. Transferability is weak: the Chicago evidence is from heat, not winter storms. It stands in for the isolation mechanism only.

4. Check CO alarms door to door in rentals, and carry the generator and grill warning in Spanish, Vietnamese, Hmong, and Mien

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sacramento Fire Department; RIL for the alarms	Door to door by 1 Dec	$5,000: about 200 alarms × ~$25 (estimate)	Carbon monoxide deaths in sleep during outages

California's SB 183 already requires CO alarms in homes with fuel-burning appliances or attached garages, so the gap is compliance and expired alarms. The message: generators outdoors only, at least 20 feet from windows; never a grill or oven for heat. In New Mexico, detectors "may have prevented approximately half" of 136 unintentional CO deaths (Yoon et al., *JAMA* 1998; a modelled estimate). Locally, on 16 April 2024, a gas generator inside a south Sacramento apartment left a mother and two children in critical condition.*

Corrections: Sacramento Fire is the partner on both sides of the line. Fruitridge Pocket is most likely in the Pacific Fruitridge Fire Protection District, which contracts with Sacramento Fire (confirm with LAFCo). No current free CO-alarm programme was found. The 2024 case was on Center Parkway, outside 95820, and was not storm-related. Fold the $5,000 into the South Land Park briefing's RIL CO line. Transferability: the New Mexico deaths were in an arid, rural state; the mechanism transfers, the proportion may not.

5. Flag hazard trees over bedrooms and tents now, and teach two household rules for wind warnings

CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City Urban Forestry; neighbourhood associations; Sacramento County for Fruitridge Pocket	Tree walks by 15 Nov, before the soil saturates	Volunteer time	Deaths and injuries from trees falling on homes, tents, and cars

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

About 1,500 trees fell citywide in January 2023. More than 1,000 were private, and most were healthy trees uprooted from saturated soil, according to the City's urban forester. Volunteers photograph large or leaning trees over bedrooms and tents now. City trees go to 311. Trees on County roads in Fruitridge Pocket go to the County (SacCounty 311); confirm the intake number before printing a flyer. Private trees are the owner's job, so the photo and a note to the owner matter most. Household rules: in a wind warning, stay off the roads, since 44% of US tree-fall deaths happen in vehicles (Schmidlin, *Natural Hazards* 2009). Sleep away from rooms under big trees, as one Tahoe Park family did in January 2023.

Transferability: Schmidlin is US-wide and peer-reviewed, and the tree counts are Sacramento's own.

6. Open a warm-and-charge room inside the ZIP during long outages, at the Fruit Ridge Community Collaborative

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Fruit Ridge Community Collaborative	Confirmed by 15 Dec; opens on each wind or atmospheric-river warning	$10,000, conditional (estimate)	Cold exposure and dead phones and devices on day two of an outage

The County's respite site is 8–10 km away, and SMUD outages in January 2023 ran for days. The Collaborative, at 4625 44th St in a former elementary school, is a known hub inside the ZIP. Release the money only after written confirmation of the building, staffing, and a backup power source.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no 990, finances, or backup-power evidence was found for the Collaborative; pay through a tenant nonprofit that files a 990 if needed. A generator at Colonial Heights Library is unverified, so the library is not named as the site.

7. File the paperwork that has to exist before the storm: SMUD's low-income rate, HEAP, CalFresh replacement, and work-rule exemptions

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FOOD | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sacramento County Dept of Human Assistance (DHA); SMUD; Community Resource Project	EAPR and HEAP filed by 15 Nov; exemption screening by 15 Dec	Staff and volunteer time; no funded line	Shutoffs, lost food, and benefit cutoffs landing in storm months

SMUD's Energy Assistance Program Rate (EAPR) takes $105 a month off at 0–50% of the poverty line, $42 at 50–100%, and $20 and $10 up to 200%. Processing takes 2–4 weeks, so file by mid-November. HEAP runs through Community Resource Project (916-567-5200). Its 2026–27 opening date is unverified, so call before promising timing. Ask the SMUD board to adopt a storm shutoff moratorium: none exists, and the only precedent ran from March 2020 to June 2021. For CalFresh, file form CF 303 within 10 days of a food loss, for up to one month's allotment. After the January 2023 storms USDA approved mass replacement in 168 ZIPs in 39 counties, including Sacramento, automatic only in the hardest-hit ZIPs. Federal work rules (H.R. 1) apply in California from 1 June 2026, now including unhoused people and veterans, and Sacramento County has no waiver from 1 November 2026 to 31 October 2027. DHA screens ABAWD-coded recipients for exemptions by 15 December. Ask Sacramento Food Bank & Family Services to pre-position no-cook boxes from its own stock before 1 December.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: no standing SMUD storm moratorium exists; this is an ask, not a protection. A "4-hour outage" CalFresh rule had no primary source and is not printed here. Whether 95820 was among the 2023 mass-replacement ZIPs is unverified.

8. Clear storm drains before the soil saturates, confirm pump power, and buy optional flood cover by 10 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · ECONOMIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT CONSULTED

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
City Dept of Utilities; households	Flood cover by 10 Nov; pump power confirmed by 1 Dec	Staff time; household premiums	Street and garage ponding, as on 59th St in 2011

Clear leaves from storm-drain inlets before the soil saturates. Report blocked inlets to City 311, or in Fruitridge Pocket to County 311 (916-875-4311 from outside the unincorporated area). Ask City Utilities to confirm by 1 December that pump stations and sumps serving 95820 have backup power. In 2023 the City ran about 100 pump stations on generators, at about $2.2 million. In March 2011, 59th St in Tahoe Park was under several inches of water. The whole ZIP is Zone X, so flood cover is optional. But NFIP authority to write new policies expires on 11 December 2026 unless Congress extends it (CRS Insight IN10835, 11 September 2026). With the standard 30-day wait, anyone who wants cover should buy by about 10 November.

Corrections: the pump-station figure comes from the South Land Park briefing and its source now returns 404. The old 875-RAIN line is retired. The 2014 flood-map change near Morrison Creek does not reach 95820, so the "formerly mapped streets" advice was dropped.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	County Public Health	CDPH	Dialysis units	SMUD	RIL	County Homeless Services	City Community Response	La Familia & partners	Fruit Ridge Collaborative	Sacramento Fire	City Urban Forestry	County 311 / roads	County DHA	Community Resource Project	City Utilities	Neighbours & households
1. Power-dependent residents	**A/R**	**C**	**R**	**R**	**R**			**I**								
2. Storm-night shelter addendum						**A/R**	**R**	**I**								
3. In-language check-ins	**C**							**A/R**	**R**							**I**
4. CO alarms and warning					**R**			**C**		**A/R**						**I**
5. Hazard trees and wind rules											**A/R**	**R**				**R**
6. Warm-and-charge room				**I**		**C**		**C**	**A/R**							**I**
7. Paperwork before the storm				**R**				**R**					**A/R**	**R**		**R**
8. Drains, pumps, flood cover												**R**			**A/R**	**R**

What the chart shows: accountability is spread across eight bodies, one per action, and no one carries more than one A. Neighbours and households carry the most rows. Only actions 1, 3, 4, and 6 need money; actions 2, 5, 7, and 8 need a decision or staff time, and the SMUD shutoff moratorium in action 7 needs a board vote.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. No placement carries a measured cost per death averted; amounts are unit-cost estimates or capacity limits, labelled as such.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$45,000	$60,000	~$78,000	Whether RIL can buy and lend batteries at this speed

Floor: RIL power stations $30,000 (30 × ~$1,000, estimate) + Iu Mien check-ins $15,000 = $45,000. Below this, the oxygen users and the language-isolated elders are not reached. **Target:** $45,000 + Fruit Ridge warm room $10,000 (conditional) + RIL CO alarms $5,000 = $60,000. **Ceiling:** $60,000 + 18 more power stations at ~$1,000 to cover all 48 oxygen users = ~$78,000 (about $97,000 at list prices). The target did not move in verification. No-cook boxes ($40,000) were not added: they overlap CalFresh replacement and County food-bank funding. If a funder insists, cap them at a $10,000 standby line.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Resources for Independent Living (FY2024–25 revenue $1.83M)	Action 1: 30 power stations of about 2 kWh, lent to device users	$30,000	Pre-positioned stock, in one pool with 95818 and 95822	30 × ~$1,000 all-in (estimate; 2 kWh units $749–899 on sale, $1,399–1,899 list). No SMUD or PG&E programme covers SMUD medical customers	Partially confirmed
Iu Mien Community Services (2024 revenue $328,273)	Action 3: in-language check-in rosters and MED forms for older residents	$15,000	Direct grant	About 4.6% of revenue: a capacity ceiling, not a costing. Catchment overlap with 95820 unverified	Partially confirmed
Fruit Ridge Community Collaborative	Action 6: powered warm-and-charge room	$10,000	Conditional grant, through a tenant nonprofit if needed	Estimate; no 990 or finances found. Release on written confirmation of building, staff, and power	Unverified
Resources for Independent Living	Action 4: about 200 CO alarms	$5,000	Direct grant, folded into South Land Park's RIL CO line ($20,000 total)	~200 × ~$25 (estimate)	Partially confirmed
Resources for Independent Living	Action 1, ceiling only: 18 more power stations	$18,000	Pre-positioned stock	Covers all 48 oxygen users at ~$1,000 each (estimate)	Partially confirmed
Sacramento Food Bank & Family Services	Action 7: no-cook boxes	$0 (was $40,000)	Ask for its own stock	~1,000 × $40 was a lens estimate; overlaps CF 303 replacement and County food-bank funding	Not funded

One RIL pool across the three Sacramento briefings. At target, RIL would receive about $250,000: Curtis Park $150,000 (100 batteries plus $30,000 case management), South Land Park $65,000 ($50,000 power stations plus $15,000 CO alarms), and this ZIP $35,000. That is about 14% of RIL's $1.83M revenue, for an activity it has not run before. Count it once: one pool of about 180 units, released in two tranches, with per-ZIP allocations. The emPOWER counts argue for rebalancing toward 95822 (512 device users) and 95820 (308), and away from Curtis Park (152).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The funder's one thing: the cheapest life saved here costs nothing. It is dialysis units moving sessions earlier before a forecast storm. After that, the money gap in 95820 is language and batteries, not sandbags.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Write a ZIP-wide plan that cites only City 311, City Urban Forestry, and City channels

CONTRAINDICATED

About 6,100 people in Fruitridge Pocket are County residents. They report trees, roads, and drains to the County, not the City. Respite itself is open to them in both systems.

Instead: print both the City and the County numbers on every flyer.

Hand out or promote generators, gas heaters, or grills for outages*

CONTRAINDICATED

Indoor combustion during outages kills by carbon monoxide, often in sleep. On 16 April 2024 a gas generator inside a south Sacramento apartment left a mother and two children in critical condition. In the January 2023 storm series, two men died at Sea Ranch with a generator running indoors.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: batteries for device users, and CO alarms. If someone already owns a generator, outdoors only, at least 20 feet from windows. Do not say "never use one": oxygen users who own one may improvise something worse.

Clear camps before a storm without a named bed to send people to

CONTRAINDICATED

Since *City of Grants Pass v. Johnson* (US Supreme Court, 28 June 2024), this is lawful. But it scatters people out of outreach's reach just before the night they most need to be found. In 2019 a cleared camp near Stockton and Fruitridge moved onto the boulevard's sidewalks.

Instead: a voluntary move to a named bed, with transport, and a log of where each person ends up (action 2).

Make sandbags and levee evacuation the headline

CONTRAINDICATED

The whole ZIP is FEMA Zone X, and the creek channels lie outside it. The recorded harm here is trees, outages, and street ponding. A flood-first message points people at the wrong danger.

Instead: lead with tree and outage safety. Mention the County sandbag sites (1 November to 1 May) for garage and low-door ponding, but do not headline them.

Rely on English-only, opt-in Sacramento Alert messages to announce respite openings or check-ins

CONTRAINDICATED

Sacramento Alert reaches only registered cell and email users. Registrations not renewed after the 2023 system change were wiped on 1 October 2023, and no current enrolment is published. Respite openings are not imminent-threat messages, so they do not go out as Wireless Emergency Alerts.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: Wireless Emergency Alerts reach phones without sign-up for imminent threats. Pair every opening with in-language phone trees (action 3).

Buy a parametric wind insurance policy for local nonprofits

CONTRAINDICATED

No off-the-shelf California wind parametric product for nonprofits was found. There is no named payer, and a custom deal cannot be bound before the peak (Curtis Park verification, 8 October 2026).

Instead: fund the placements above directly.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Feb 1986	Countywide flood; the city's levees came close to failing (ENSO-neutral to weak La Niña)	13 dead countywide	SAFCA formed in 1989
Jan 1995	Morrison and Florin creeks flood locally, south of the ZIP; blamed on drainage failure (moderate El Niño)	None found in 95820	South Sacramento Streams works, 1996–2017
Mar 2011	More than 2 inches of rain in hours; 59th St in Tahoe Park under several inches (La Niña)	None found	None recorded
2015–16	A strong El Niño under-delivers in Northern California	—	—
Jan 2021	A Tahoe Park tree narrowly misses a house; date inferred (La Niña)	0	None recorded

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2021	Sacramento County records 199 unhoused deaths, 8 from hypothermia, more than the previous 19 years combined	8 hypothermia deaths, countywide	—
Dec 2021	Respite centres closed on the first night of a rainstorm (La Niña)	None found	Centres opened later in the storm
Dec 2022 – Jan 2023	Atmospheric rivers: ~345,000 SMUD customers out at peak (~599,000 outages in all); ~1,500 trees down citywide (La Niña)	2 unhoused people killed by trees on tents (N. 5th St and North Highlands, not in 95820)	City broadened its respite trigger to wind and rain (Aug 2023)
Apr 2024	Indoor gas generator, Center Parkway, south Sacramento; not storm-related	Mother and two children critical	—
Nov 2025	County wind and rain respite at 4000 Branch Center Rd, with free RT rides	—	A County wind and rain activation exists

The recurrence nobody has noticed: protection here improved only after a near-miss (1986 led to SAFCA; 2023 led to the respite trigger). The storm that matters arrives in any ENSO phase: the worst winter on this record was a La Niña one, and the strongest El Niño under-delivered.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Brand this as El Niño preparedness** (the briefing's framing) versus **do not call anything here an "El Niño programme"** (skeptic): a dry winter would discredit it, and the next storm would find it defunded. Resolved in practice: every action fires on a storm forecast, not the label.
- **Buy flood cover and fix drains** (historian, economist) versus **flood is not the harm here** (skeptic). FEMA maps the whole ZIP as Zone X, so drains stay in and flood cover is optional.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

No storm death or outage-duration record exists at ZIP level. The County has no excess-mortality baseline for outage days, so the programme cannot show it saved anyone. In the 2003 New York blackout, non-accidental deaths rose 25% while officials attributed about 6 deaths to the outage (Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012; a summer outage). There is also no current count of unhoused people inside 95820.

HOW TO READ THIS

METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; wind, falling trees, outages, cold, and local flooding are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named 95820. It is treated as ZCTA 95820 (35,410 people, ACS 2024 5-year). The Census 2020 ZCTA–place relationship file splits its land three ways: City of Sacramento 12.09 km², Fruitridge Pocket CDP 1.53 km² (all of the CDP), and Lemon Hill CDP 0.02 km². Lemon Hill and Fruitridge Manor are therefore treated as outside the ZIP. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: Sacramento County, CA, inferred rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not this place's winter hazard, so the historical record carries the hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Curtis Park and South Land Park briefings (8 October 2026, same county) served as an evidence pack; items re-used from them are labelled.

- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted in an action's favour: several lenses placed Lemon Hill and Fruitridge Manor in the ZIP from the same secondary listing, and the Census relationship file showed they are not. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Four separate verifier agents checked the 8 actions, 6 contraindicated items, the scope, and the funding placements on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability, a named payer, a trigger, and whether they already exist. Verifiers queried HHS emPOWER, the Census relationship file, TIGERweb, FEMA's flood map (NFHL) against the full ZIP polygon, and USGS NHD directly, and read IRS filings on ProPublica. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Reader.** No role was given, so the For you section is written for a resident. It was added on 26 October 2026, after this briefing was first sent; its steps come from the verified actions and were checked on the same three tests.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not consulted for this location. No action here is marked as having or lacking a precedent there.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (medical equipment in an outage, carbon monoxide, generators and grills, and falling trees) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. The impact region was not resolved on the Impact Map. The DHA website did not resolve, ABC10 returned 403, SMUD's MED

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

page returned 404, the OpenFEMA API was down, and the RIL website did not resolve. A 4-hour CalFresh outage rule had no primary source and is omitted. The 2023 pump-station cost rests on a source that now returns 404. The County's tree-intake number, Iu Mien Community Services' exact address, and whether 95820 was among USDA's 2023 mass-replacement ZIPs were not confirmed. ENSO phases are from NOAA's ONI table as the lenses reported them.

References · HHS emPOWER, ZIP 95820 (queried 26 Oct 2026) · HHS emPOWER identified dataset (verified) · HHS emPOWER FAQ (verified) · State emPOWER fact sheet (Missouri, Aug 2026) (verified) · Lurie et al. 2015, early dialysis (verified, re-used) · SMUD Medical Equipment Discount (re-used; page 404 on 26 Oct) · PG&E DDAR fact sheet (verified) · CFILC DDAR fact sheet (verified) · RIL, IRS filings (verified) · 2 kWh power station price, EcoFlow (verified) · 2 kWh power station price, Jackery (verified) · Census Reporter, ZCTA 95820 (verified) · Census 2020 ZCTA–place relationship file (queried) · Fruitridge Pocket (verified) · Lemon Hill (verified) · CDC PLACES, ZCTA 95820 (lens) · City weather respite criteria (verified) · City broadens respite criteria, Aug 2023 (verified) · County wind and rain respite, Nov 2025 (verified) · City–County Partnership Agreement, 2022 (verified) · Outreach and Engagement Center, winter 2022–23 (verified) · 199 unhoused deaths in 2021 (lens) · County coroner, Jan 2023 tree deaths (lens) · Respite centres closed, Dec 2021 (lens) · Stockton Blvd camp clearing, 2019 (lens) · La Familia Counseling Center (verified) · Fruit Ridge Community Collaborative (verified) · SacDOT trees in County right-of-way, 311 (verified 26 Oct) · City neighbourhood directory, South Oak Park (verified) · Iu Mien Community Services, IRS filings (verified) · Semenza et al., *NEJM* 1996;335:84–90 (verified; heat-wave evidence) · Yoon et al., *JAMA* 1998 (verified) · South Sacramento generator CO case, Apr 2024 (verified) · Pacific Fruitridge Fire Protection District (verified) · Metro Fire smoke-alarm blitz, 2020 (verified) · City tree damage, Jan 2023 (verified) · Schmidlin 2009, tree-fall deaths (verified) · Tahoe Park family, Jan 2023 (lens; snippet only, page 403) · Tahoe Park tree, Jan 2021 (lens; date inferred) · SMUD storm outages, 2023 (lens) · Sacramento outages, Jan 2023 (lens) · SMUD EAPR (verified) · SMUD Rule 11 (verified) · SMUD COVID shutoff suspension, 2020 (verified) · Community Resource Project (HEAP) (verified; no 2026–27 date) · LIHEAP FY2027 release (verified) · CDSS form CF 303 (verified) · CalFresh replacement rules (county handbook) (verified) · USDA 2023 mass replacement (verified) · CDSS ABAWD waivers (verified) · Sacramento Food Bank & Family Services (verified) · CRS IN10835, NFIP authorization (verified) · FEMA NFHL flood zones (queried) · 2014 South Sacramento map revision (verified; outside 95820) · County drainage requests (verified) · 59th St flooding, Mar 2011 (lens) · County flood history (lens) · SAFCA (lens) · City FAQ on Grants Pass (verified) · Sacramento Alert data deletion, 2023 (verified) · Sacramento Alert FAQ (verified) · Anderson & Bell 2012 (lens) · NOAA ONI table (ENSO phases as the lenses reported them)
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory
Generated 26 October 2026 for ZIP 95820, Tahoe Park and Colonial Heights, Sacramento. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.